

1.)Wallenius Wilhelmsen's next generation vessels are coming!

"I am very happy that we can launch this to the market now. I know it is expected from us, and that in order to keep our fleet size, we need to continue ordering vessels. However, with no clear direction on future fuel, this has not been an easy task. We needed time to assess what was the best option for us," says Xavier Leroi, EVP & COO Shipping Services.

The wait is over! Wallenius Wilhelmsen is proud to share that we have signed a letter of intent for four firm, and eight optional, next generation vessels!

It's been a long time coming, but after meticulous planning and hard work from everyone involved, we can finally share that we have signed a letter of intent for four next generation vessels (and up to eight optional units of 9,350CEU class methanol dual fuel pure car and truck carriers) with Jinling Shipyard (Jiangsu). The first vessels will start being delivered from the second half of 2026.

The Shaper Class

"There is an urgent need for our industry to transform over the next couple of years. As a company, we are determined to shape this industry and lead the way to capitalize effectively on changing circumstances, as we grow with customers and partners sharing our journey," says Lasse Kristoffersen, CEO.

And these are not just four new ordinary vessels! We are committed to being a shaper, not an adapter. We want to be transformational in the fight against climate change and all of Wallenius Wilhelmsen's new investments will contribute to reaching our ambitious climate targets.

As such, as a pledge to this ambition, it is only fitting that our new vessel class is named "The Shaper Class".

We have high ambitions for the future. We want to be our customers' first choice in shipping and we want to deliver an end-to-end net-zero emissions solution by 2027. Our new vessels will enable us to get closer to these goals. At the same time, we are the world's largest RoRo vessel operator and will maintain a fleet of 125-135 vessels.

Lars Ekren, Senior Manager – Newbuildings and Conversions explains: "The process of developing our new design started over 1.5 year ago and the Newbuildings team have been working in close collaboration with the designer (Delta Marin) and internal & external stakeholders during this period, to ensure the vessel design meets of safety requirements and is well suitable for our future short term & long-term operational needs," he continues, "Energy efficiency & reducing GHG emissions is a top priority, and a lot of effort has put into ensuring the new vessels will significantly contribute to meeting our emission reduction targets!"

Our commitment

Our commitment is to continue to grow with our customers, and together, reach our net-zero emissions ambitions. We will do so by securing new builds and biofuels, as well as maintaining the 125-135 vessels on our fleet. We will evolve whilst nurturing our reliable services, tailored to our customers' needs.

"To secure our number one position, we will continue to deliver great services with a competitive fleet, offering sustainable supply chain services both on land and at sea. We are already partnering with our customers on reducing emissions through biofuel and with the new vessels we can accelerate this towards net-zero. This requires new and more expensive fuels but both we and our customers are committed to secure this as soon as it can be made available," says Leroi.

Our belief is that methanol is the fastest way to reach net-zero emission. As such, our choices going forward reflect that. These four vessels have been ordered to use alternative fuel sources, such as methanol, upon delivery. They will also be ammonia-ready and will be able to be converted as soon as ammonia becomes available in a safe and secure way.

So here's to the "Shaper Class". We hope you're excited because together, we will shape the future!

2.) Oceanbird is a concept for wind-powered cargo vessels under development by Wallenius Marine. The concept aims to lower emissions by up to 90 percent^{[1][2]} and the design was developed in collaboration with KTH Royal Institute of Technology and Swedish maritime technology company SSPA. Financial backing for the development was provided by the Swedish Transport Agency.^[2] In 2021, Wallenius announced a partnership with Swedish heavy industry company Alfa Laval to further develop the concept's wingsail design.^[3] Construction of a full-scale prototype wing was commenced in 2023, to be installed ashore at Landskrona to test the concept and to develop the crew operation and automation aspects.^[4] Meanwhile, Wilhelmsen's car carrier Tirranna has been prepared to receive the second prototype wing, which is planned to be fitted in early 2025.^[5]

The concept features expandable wingsails that can rotate 360 degrees and tilt down if needed. The masts will measure 40 m (130 ft) for a total height above the waterline of 65 m (213 ft). The rigging will be made from steel and composite materials and resemble airplane wings.^[6] An auxiliary engine will be used to navigate harbors and provide emergency power.^[7]

While the design is meant to be usable for different types of ships and even retrofitted to existing vessels,^[7] the first vessel from the Oceanbird concept is planned to be a 200 m (660 ft) long roll-on/roll-off ship with a capacity of up to 7,000 cars. Such ships are optimized for transatlantic routes. The first vessel based on the concept is planned to set sail in 2026.^[8]

In February 2021, shipping company Wallenius Wilhelmsen announced their intention to order a vessel of the Oceanbird concept, tentatively named Orcelle Wind.^[9]

Partnership with ABBA Voyage

In May 2022, Wallenius was confirmed as the official partner to the concert residency ABBA Voyage in London.[10] In this partnership, Wallenius will act as the exclusive logistics provider for ABBA Voyage, in addition to providing support and consultation around sustainability. The partnership also allows for future Oceanbird vessels to be named after ABBA songs. Inside the ABBA Arena in London, the VIP lounge section is named The Oceanbird Departure Lounge, as an homage to the namesake wind-powered concept.

3.)Wallenius Wilhelmsen announces another solid quarter

Wallerenius Wilhelmsen reported strong performance for the first quarter of 2024 with EBITDA at USD 438m and a net profit of USD 185m.

“We are very pleased with our results in Q1 2024, in particular in view of the impacts from multiple, external events. Shipping volumes and available capacity were negatively impacted by the rerouting away from the Red Sea. In addition, the bridge collapse in Baltimore impacted operations on the US east coast. Despite this, and thanks to our teams' extraordinary efforts, we delivered another strong quarter,” says Lasse Kristoffersen, President, and CEO at Wallenius Wilhelmsen.

The first quarter of 2024 reflected continued high activity and profitability across all segments, despite geopolitical and operational challenges. Q1 EBITDA was USD 438m, of which shipping delivered USD 366m, logistics USD 46m and government USD 34m.

Increased demand for integrated services

With capacity constraints ongoing, many customers are increasingly looking to secure integrated shipping and logistics solutions ahead of scheduled contract renewals. “In 2024, a substantial portion of our contracts are due for renewal. Scarcity of shipping capacity provides a firm backdrop for negotiations and business activity. We see increased demand for logistics and integrated services, and support for the ambition to reduce emissions,” says Kristoffersen.

Delivering on CO2 intensity targets and setting new goals

Wallerenius Wilhelmsen met the CO2 intensity target set for 2023, enshrined in the sustainability-linked financing framework established in 2022, and is actively committing to new net zero goals. “We have upped our ambitions on decarbonization with a goal of reducing our emissions by 40% by 2030 (compared to 2022) and becoming net zero by 2040,” says Kristoffersen.

During the quarter Wallenius Wilhelmsen also ordered four additional Shaper Class methanol dual fuel vessels, for a total of eight firm orders. Further, the company utilizes various energy efficiency measures and vessel upgrades to further reduce the fleet’s emissions. The newbuilds and energy efficiency initiatives are key elements in the company’s journey towards net zero.

Despite the financial implications of external events, the company expects 2024 to be another strong year, somewhat better than 2023.

4.)Wallenius Wilhelmsen joins the First Movers Coalition

As we move forward with our Shaper Class newbuilding program and continue to take practical steps on our journey towards net zero, we believe the time is now right to join the First Movers Coalition.

Joined up thinking

The leading global public-private partnership, the First Movers Coalition (FMC) is working to scale the most critical, emerging climate technologies required to decarbonize the world's heavy-emitting sectors. Clearly aligning with our strategic goals, our commitment is unique, covering our activities at sea and onshore.

"I am delighted to confirm that Wallenius Wilhelmsen ASA will join the First Movers Coalition with commitments in both the Shipping and Logistics sectors," says Lasse Kristoffersen, CEO of Wallenius Wilhelmsen.

At Wallenius Wilhelmsen we have set ambitious targets for 2030 in both sectors: to ensure that at least 5% of our deep-sea shipping operations are powered by zero-emission fuels and that at least 30% of our new heavy-duty truck purchases are zero-emission vehicles.

In addition, joining working groups for both our ocean and land sectors is particularly important with our clearly stated ambition to offer a zero-emission end-to-end service by 2027.

Collaboration is key

Working together with various peers from across the shipping and logistics industries, we hope to benefit from both knowledge sharing and by building consensus around how we best communicate future fuel needs to the market in a coherent and focused way.

Acknowledging our path to net zero is a collaborative effort, we are actively encouraging industry peers and partners to participate. "Wallenius Wilhelmsen will aim to support member recruitment and actively participate in the development of coalition activities," adds Kristoffersen.

The innovative FMC project was initiated in 2021 by the World Economic Forum and the Office of the US Special Presidential Envoy for Climate, John Kerry. Today FMC includes 96 members, such as Coca-Cola, Amazon, Ford, Google, Rio Tinto, Microsoft, and Maersk. It aims to prompt market demand for technologies critical for achieving a net-zero future.

Wallenius Wilhelmsen's involvement emphasizes our dedication to leading the industry towards a more sustainable future through actionable, science-based efforts to combat climate change.